



OHIO TRAIL NORTH SHORE FEASIBILITY STUDY

Steering Committee Meeting

Agenda – January 23rd, 2012

I. Project Schedule

II. Key Person/Stakeholders Interviews

- A. *Preparation of List – Key Elected Officials from Each Municipality*
- B. *Municipal Survey – Status Review, Return by January 31st*

III. Funding and Implementation

- A. *TCSP Grant Submission*
- B. *Other Implementation Strategies*

IV. Discussion

- A. *Review of Alternative Analysis*

Ohio River North Shore Trail Feasibility Study- Project Schedule - January 23, 2012

	MONTHS											
	Aug	Sept.	Oct.	Nov.	Dec.	Jan.	Feb.	Mar., Apr., My.	June	July		
Study Committee Meetings		◆		◆	◆	◆	◆	◆				
Public Meetings					◆	◆		◆				◆
Data Collection and GIS Mapping												
Refine the Goals of the Plan												
Define Demand and Potential												
Route Planning												
Alternative Development												
Review and Evaluation												
PennDOT/SPC Mtg.							◆					
Draft Report Documents												
Review By Cmt and Municipalities												
Final Report Documents												

◆ Agency Coordination Meeting
◆ Joint Public ORTC Board Meetings

MINUTES OF MEETING



**STROMBERG™
GARRIGAN
& ASSOCIATES, INC.**

Landscape Architects & Planners
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PROJECT: City of Monaca, PA – Midland ORT North Shore

SGA PROJECT #: 11009

DATE: December 5, 2011

ATTENDING: Sean Garrigan, Nick Baran (SGA), Chuck Jones (Mackin Engineering Co.)

Note: See attached sign-in sheet for list of steering committee and their contact info.

SUBJECT: North Shore Trail Feasibility Steering Committee & Public Meeting

❖ General Comments from Steering Committee Meeting

- Project is currently ahead of schedule which will help to provide adequate time to address issue focused on the more challenging segments of the study corridor.
- Several on site studies have been conducted and Chuck Jones of Mackin Engineering has been collecting PENDOT drawings and plans which have been reviewed.
- A draft plan for the Ohio River Trail North Shore is tentatively on schedule to be done by late March, 2012. Once this is ready, the local community leaders will have several months to review the plan and make comments on the material.
- Another day of field work is needed. In particular, the old trolley line north of Route 68 in Ohioville needs to be examined further. The portion of Route 68 that parallels what was once the interurban trolley line is a section that has variable shoulder conditions and traffic volumes, resulting in conditions that may not be ideal for a bike lanes/sharrows, depending on the context.
- Opinions and comments from some local officials and community leaders are still needed. Brett Hollern of SGA will be conducting interviews via phone to complete this information. This list of contacts still needs to be determined with input from the Steering Committee.
- A municipality survey will also be sent out to ascertain community opinions regarding the North Shore Trail. All of these opinions, including those voiced at the public meetings held on December 5th and January 23rd, will be compiled and used to influence further trail design. A hard copy and electronic copy of the survey tool was provided to the Steering Committee.
- There was a discussion about the western end of Midland along Rt. 68 which could be a pinch point in the trail and could benefit from the discussion of alternatives.

❖ Key Issues from the Steering Committee Meeting

- A discussion regarding implementation of this trail (including the South Shore) was held. This discussion began to address mechanism to fund the first implementation projects. This includes pulling together the cooperative agreement model and organizational structures needed for trails maintenance and upkeep in the future. Those who handle the implementation do not necessarily have to be the same group who handles the maintenance and upkeep. This discussion was related

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to North Shore, based on what was determined to be the most acceptable model for the South Shore.

- One of the key issues discussed related to moving implementation forward is that the Ohio River Trail Council is generally adverse to acquiring land. This is where another conservancy group may be able to step in.

Next Steps & Post Meeting Action Item List

1. The next public meeting is to occur on January 23, 2012. The consultant team will be evaluating all alignments identified to this point, including input from the December 5, 2011 public meeting. The January public meeting will give the public an opportunity to respond to initial evaluations related to trail alignment performed to-date. Segments that can be identified as "preferred" will be designated in order to hone in on those segments that will require further study.
2. There are new federal funding opportunities that could help to move this project along such as the Transportation, Community, and System Preservation (TCSP) Program. The funding, however, requires a match with a non-federal source. The breakdown would be approximately 80% funding from the federal level and a 20% match from state or local agencies. The deadline to apply for this funding is in early January so action should be taken soon if this is something that the committee is interested in pursuing.
3. There was a discussion regarding the Ohio River Trail Council establishing a committee dedicated to acquiring funding for the project. Jason Reyes of Alta Planning and Design mentioned that this committee should be multi-faceted, ideally with a mix of representations, including trail advocates and those ideally representing partner community governments, staff, etc.

Comments from the Public Meeting

- Concerns were raised regarding how trail organizers would address community members who are apprehensive about having a portion of the trail cross their property. SGA replied by saying that the best way to handle these situation is to get to the root of the issue and determine what it is in particular that is causing the hesitation. If the issue is privacy or security, there are studies showing how typical trail users are college educated, middle class law-abiding citizens who enjoy community recreation opportunities. Safety can also be designed for by decreasing the number of "hidden corners" and places for mischievous activities. In extreme cases, fencing could be established though, as Brett Hollern pointed out, the root of the concern should be determined in order to limit the level of commitment to special conditions because it could become an element that makes the trail project (or segment) more cost prohibitive. He pointed out that if neighbor "A" wants a fence, then neighbor "B" may want a fence even if it is not warranted and soon the cost of the project becomes much higher than originally anticipated. If property values are a concern, there are studies showing how property values actually increase when a trail is located nearby as it is seen as an amenity in the real estate market. SGA will perform some

research to see if there are some applicable case studies that can be provided to ease landowner concerns.

- There was public interest in whether or not the local police departments have come out in support of this project. SGA replied by saying that while they have not specifically written any sort of statement in support, some are aware of the project. In terms of trail safety, emergency vehicle access is being considered in the design. What general happens in these circumstances is that local police will begin to include the trail in their routine patrols. Sometimes this patrol includes the support of bicycle police along the trail. At the time a draft preferred alignment is determined it would be helpful for liaisons to the local communities assist in outreach to local public safety leaders.

IF YOU ATTENDED THE SEPTEMBER STEERING COMMITTEE MEETING YOU ONLY NEED TO SIGN-IN

1

SIGN IN SHEET

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Ohio River Trail North Shore Feasibility Study
Public Workshop December 5th, 2011
Exit Survey RESPONSES

Please take a moment to fill out this survey. Thank you.

1. In which of the municipalities do you reside?

(3) Beaver, (3) N. Sewickley Twp.,
(2) Rochester Twp., (1) Rochester
Borough, (1) Center Twp., (1) New
Brighton (1) Chippewa Twp.

If none, what is your interest in the project?

(3) Bike riding & exercising, (1) work
in beaver, (1) recreation, (1) on board
of Beaver River rails to trails, (1)
Quality of life economic development

2. Who lives in your household?

(circle all that apply)

- a. Pre-schoolers
- b. Elementary students (1)
- c. Middle school students (1)
- d. Junior high students (1)
- e. High school students (2)
- f. Young adults (1)
- g. Working adults (10)
- h. Retired adults (6)
- i. People with disabilities

3. Which of the topics are the most important to you in relation to the project planning process? (circle no more than three)

- a. Connecting to regional trails (11)
- b. Creating local community (9)
trails/paths or circuits
- c. Making parks and destinations (7)
within your community more
accessible by walking or bicycling
- d. Connecting your neighborhood to
the Ohio River's or the Beaver
River's edge (7)

- e. Promoting economic development (5)
- f. Other passive recreation
opportunities (3)
- g. Safer routes to schools (1)
- h. Historic interpretation (4)

4. Which from question #3 is the most important to you and why?

(10 A) Connecting regional trails

Very little access and need to travel out to ride

Need more trails in Beaver County

(1 B.) Because it is so inaccessible now

(2.C.) Economic Development,
Job growth

Environmental

More opportunities for fitness

Will boost local businesses

5. If we could do one thing to make your community safer for bicyclists or pedestrians, what do you think that should be?

Eliminate cars

Really safe marked trails and bike lanes
along with education

Safe bike path

Connect the trail from Coraopolis to
Monaca

Off-road trail access

Good parking trail heads

Widen & mark bike path on major routes
like 51 & 18

Publicize the location of the bike with info
on these trails

Maybe use trails more and road less

Trails that interconnect

Share the road signing.

6. Is there a location in your community that you feel should be safely accessible for bicyclists and pedestrians, via a trail, and is not today?

Beaver River Valley,
North of Beaver Falls
Junction stretch to Riverside Park
Rochester Riverfront Park
The Stretch along the Beaver River
from Beaver Falls to Koppel
Raccoon Park from one end to the
other a trail from the old valley picnic
area to the beach and so on.

The following is a list of recreation activities. Please indicate if members of your household participate or would like to participate in the following activities.

	Yes	No	Would like to
a. Walking as an activity	Y	N	WL (14 Y)
b. Bicycling	Y	N	WL (14 Y)
c. Mountain Biking	Y	N	WL (3Y) (2N) (1WL)
d. Roller Blading	Y	N	WL (2N)
e. League sports (e.g. baseball, soccer, etc.)	Y	N	WL (1Y) (3N)
f. Non-league sports (e.g. golf, tennis, etc.)	Y	N	WL (3Y) (1N)
g. Exercise and fitness (such as gym, Y)	Y	N	WL (3Y) (1N)
h. Enjoy nature	Y	N	WL (8Y)
i. Bird watching	Y	N	WL (5Y) (2N)
j. Fishing	Y	N	WL (3Y) (2N)
k. Organized recreation programs	Y	N	WL (1Y) (1N)
l. Local special events (concerts, fairs)	Y	N	WL (4Y) (1N) (1WL)
m. Volunteerism	Y	N	WL (5Y) (2N)
n. Day camp	Y	N	WL (1Y) (2N)
O. Playgrounds	Y	N	WL (1Y) (1N0) (1WL)
p. Other (please specify)	Y	N	WL

10 Any additional comments or questions:

- (2) Thank you. Keep the views from the trail in mind.
- Could we get the county/commissioners and planners behind trails?
- I'm a Beaver Co. bicyclist and I travel to Allegheny & Westmoreland Counties to ride bike trails and I buy supplies, meals, overnight lodging. We should have that economic development in Beaver Co.
- I would like to see a trail from 11th street in Beaver Falls, follow 11th St. to 3rd Ave, crossing 7th Ave along 5th street and onto Beaver Falls, New Brighton Bridge, and along 2nd Ave. in New Briziton, and continuing to the YMCA Rochester



OHIO TRAIL NORTH SHORE FEASIBILITY STUDY – January 23, 2012

Municipal Key Person Interview Selection List - Please circle one or two names (rank #1 and #2) per municipality for a key person interview to discuss overall trail support, long term ownership and management commitments, etc. If you have direct contact information please provide if possible.

City of Beaver Falls

Karl Boak, Mayor

Marlo D. Cleckley, Sr. - *Public Works (Street Dept. & WPCP)*

George S. Quay III - *Code Enforcement & Fire Dept.*

John "Chuckie" Kirkland - *Parks & Recreation*

Leonard Chiappetta - *Accounts & Finance*

Jerry Ford - *City Controller*

Beaver Borough

Shirley Sayers, President of Council – Ward 3

Walt McDermott, – Ward 1

Daniel Deceder – Ward 3

Luke Berardelli – Ward 1

Mr. Patrick Sims – Ward 1

Kathryn Nestor – Ward 2

Jarrold Thomas – Ward 2

J. Lauson Cashdollar – Ward 2

Michael Deelo – Ward 3

Mayor Thomas Hamilton 724-773-6701

Manager Whitney Brady 724-773-6700

Bridgewater Borough

Bill Rains

Tim Reddinger

Scott Hopkins

Robert Eichenlaub

Jack McMullen

Heidi Paul - Mayor

Brighton Township

John Curtaccio, Chairman

James E. Equels, Sr., Vice-Chairman

Mark Piccirilli, Supervisor

Bryan K. Dehart, Township Manager

Fallston Borough

Patrick Colalella - President
Livio Pagani - Mayor
Theodore Smakosz - Vice President
Barbara Pagani - Secretary
Lisa Peacock
David Auditori
Lori Weber

Industry Borough

N/A

New Brighton Borough

Mark Kaufold (D - Third Ward) - Council President
Robert Hartwick (D - Third Ward) - Council Vice President
Thomas E. Albanese (D - Second Ward)
Ronald A. Benson (D - Fifth Ward)
David Florentine (D - First Ward)
Richard Haddox (D - Fifth Ward)
Thomas Holaren (D - Second Ward)
Valerie McElvy (D - Fourth Ward)
Donald Mittner (D - Fourth Ward)
John C. Ramer (D - First Ward)
Larry R. Morley - Manager

Midland Borough

N/A

Ohioville Borough

ROBERT A. OURS - PRESIDENT OF COUNCIL
WALTER L. STEFF JR. - VICE-PRESIDENT OF COUNCIL
KEVIN E. CHAFFEE
RICHARD B. DECKER JR.
KENNETH K. DOUGHTY
ROBERT J. WARD JR.
ROBERT C. BOYDE JR.

Rochester Borough

N/A

Rochester Township

N/A

Vanport Township

N/A